part of the marine environment (ref. UNCLOS article 196).

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
as preventing the intentional or accidental introduction of species, alien or new, to a particular part of the marine environment (ref. UNCLOS article 196).

4.3 The objective of these Guidelines is pursued by providing a globally consistent approach to stakeholders on the control and management of biofouling, which will contribute to minimizing the risk of transferring invasive aquatic species from biofouling on ships. An additional effect of good biofouling management can be a reduction in emissions to air from ships, due to lower fuel demand in operation as a result of a clean hull.

5 DESIGN AND CONSTRUCTION

5.1 Initial ship design and construction offers the most comprehensive, effective and long-lasting means to minimize ship biofouling risks. In the design and construction of a ship, or when a ship is being significantly modified, the following items, not e xhaustive, should be taken into consideration:

.1 small niches and sheltered areas should be avoided as far as practical, e.g. flush mounting pipes in sea chests (where not practical, these should be designed so that they may be easily accessed for inspection, cleaning and

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
.1 small niches and sheltered areas should be avoided as far as practical, e.g. flush mounting pipes in sea chests (where not practical, these should be designed so that they may be easily accessed for inspection, cleaning and application of AFS like marine growth prevention systems (MGPS));

.2 rounding and/or bevelling of corners, gratings and protrusions to promote more effective coverage of AFC and hinging of gratings to enable diver access;

.3 providing the capacity to block off the sea chest and other areas, such as moon pools, floodable docks and other free -flood spaces, for cleaning and treatment, if applicable and appropriate; and

.4 internal seawater cooling systems should be designed with a minimum number of bends and flanges. The design should be made of appropriate material to minimize biofouling, and be compatible with MGPS, if any. Dead ends, as can be found between different systems like cross-over piping between cooling and general service systems, should be avoided. Standby pumps and piping should be fully integrated into the systems to avoid stagnant water.

RESOLUTION MEPC.378(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf

between cooling and general service systems, should be avoided. Standby pumps and piping should be fully integrated into the systems to avoid stagnant water.

6 ANTI-FOULING SYSTEM INSTALLATION AND MAINTENANCE

6.1 AFS are effective means to minimize biofouling on ships' submerged surfaces, including the hull and niche areas.

6.2 Restrictions on the use of certain substances in the AFC are regulated by the AFS Convention.

Choosing an AFS

6.3 It is recommended to install AFS in all submerged surfaces on a ship where biofouling may attach. Various AFS are designed for different ship operating profiles, some suitable for hull and some for niche areas and therefore will require different maint enance activities. Thus, it is essential that shipowners, ship operators and shipbuilders obtain appropriate technical advice. AFS manufacturers are best suited to provide advice to ensure a suitable

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
Thus, it is essential that shipowners, ship operators and shipbuilders obtain appropriate technical advice. AFS manufacturers are best suited to provide advice to ensure a suitable system is applied, reapplied, installed or renewed. As b iofouling may typically be found at higher abundance in niche areas, where flow characteristics change as the ship moves through the water, it is recommended to choose a combination of AFC and MGPS, suitable for different submerged areas. If an appropriate AFS is not applied, biofouling accumulation may increase, and more frequent inspections may be necessary. Some factors to consider when choosing an AFS include the following:

.1 Ship design and construction: Where possible and appropriate upon the recommendation of AFS manufacturers, targeted installation of AFS may be employed for different areas of the ship. AFS for the hull may include specific AFC, paint and/or surface treatment. Installation of any proac tive cleaning measures should be in accordance with the recommendations from the AFC provider and should not damage the AFC. Different AFS are designed to

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
AFC, paint and/or surface treatment. Installation of any proac tive cleaning measures should be in accordance with the recommendations from the AFC provider and should not damage the AFC. Different AFS are designed to optimize their performance for specific ship speeds. For niche areas, the selected AFS should be optimized for conditions of the niche area, e.g. an

AFC may be recommended for use in combination with effective MGPS to minimize biofouling. AFC selection should be based on expected wear, abrasion and water flow rates.

.2 Active ingredients of AFC: Environmental impact assessment of the selected AFC with respect to the release of harmful substances should be considered. The limitations of an AFC to minimize biofouling should be known and may include operating profile, aquatic environment, ship desig n and life cycle of AFC. Decision makers should be aware of the limitations of each AFC and the recommended in -water cleaning methods in order to minimize potential environmental impacts and damage to the system. Depending on the type of AFC, various types of waste substances may be released when cleaning. Some waste substances may easily be captured

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
minimize potential environmental impacts and damage to the system. Depending on the type of AFC, various types of waste substances may be released when cleaning. Some waste substances may easily be captured but others are fine particles or dissolved substances that may be released into the water. Therefore, not all AFC types are design ed for frequent cleaning. The AFC manufacturers should provide key information on any biocides used and coating types on publicly available safety and technical datasheets. Frequent cleaning may impact the effectiveness of a specific AFC, and it is therefo re recommended that the AFC manufacturers provide relevant guidance. In-water cleaning service providers and manufacturers of cleaning methods/equipment should provide guidance considering compatibility with AFC type.

.3 Operating profile: Patterns of use, operating routes, ship activity levels and

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
MINIMIZE THE TRANSFER OF INVASIVE AQUATIC SPECIESMEPC 80/17/Add.1
Annex 17, page 11

I:\MEPC\80\MEPC 80-17-Add.1.docx
.3 Operating profile: Patterns of use, operating routes, ship activity levels and periods of inactivity may influence the rate of biofouling accumulation and thus the effectiveness of the AFS. Inactivity may cause higher accumulation of biofouling. Biofouling may attach more easily on slow-moving ships.

.4 Aquatic environment: Biofouling pressure differs between areas, depending on temperature, salinity and nutrient conditions. Biofouling grows

more slowly, but is not prevented, in low temperature waters. Ships operating in ice conditions should consider special AFC . Different organisms grow in different salinity waters and, if a ship operates in all salinity ranges, the anti-fouling system should target a wide range of organisms causing fouling. The benthic (seabed) environment should also be considered. Increasing depth of water and distance from shore may decrease susceptibility for biofouling. Additionally, higher content of nutrients in the water may increase algal blooms and susceptibility to biofouling.

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
depth of water and distance from shore may decrease susceptibility for biofouling. Additionally, higher content of nutrients in the water may increase algal blooms and susceptibility to biofouling.

.5 Cleaning method: Although cleaning system manufacturers are encouraged to find technological solutions that allow them to clean a wide variety of AFC, not all AFC can be cleaned by every cleaning system. When selecting the AFC, the available cleaning technologies and techniques and their suitability for the specific AFC should be considered. Therefore, AFC manufacturers should provide key information on any biocides used and coating types . The choice of AFC should be compatible